

# Marketing Attribution

This doc outlines how Marketing measures its contribution to pipeline and revenue through meeting attribution and multi-touch pipeline attribution models.

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## Overview

**What it does:** Attribution models assign value to marketing engagements that contribute to meetings, pipeline creation, and closed deals—allowing us to understand which campaigns and channels drive business outcomes.

**Why it matters:** By tracking attribution, we can:

- Identify which tactics generate the most meetings and pipeline
- Allocate budget to high-performing channels
- Understand the full customer journey across multiple touchpoints
- Measure Marketing's contribution to revenue

**Key principle:** No single engagement can claim full credit for a deal. Our models recognize that deals are built through multiple touchpoints across multiple people at an account over time.

**Business context:** Given Benchling's long sales cycles (weeks to 2+ years depending on segment), attribution must account for engagements that happen far before a deal is created. We use a 180-day lookback window from the sales-accepted stage.

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## Meeting Attribution

Meeting attribution is the **primary Marketing KPI**. Unlike pipeline attribution (which varies by deal size and excludes renewals), meeting attribution works consistently across all deal types and segments.

**Definition:** A meeting is credited to Marketing when:

| Condition                                                                                     | Credit Window           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Meeting scheduled/occurs within 30 days of a <b>person</b> engaging with a marketing campaign | 30 days post-engagement |
| Meeting occurs during an Event campaign with the <b>person</b> at the event                   | Event dates             |

### Meeting types that count:

- Qualification Calls
- New Business Meetings

### Why meetings matter:

- Consistent metric across deal types (new business, expansion, renewal)
- Not dependent on deal value (which fluctuates)

- Faster feedback loop than pipeline or revenue attribution
- Directly measures Marketing's ability to generate Sales conversations

Link to: [\[LINK: Meeting Attribution Reporting\]](#)

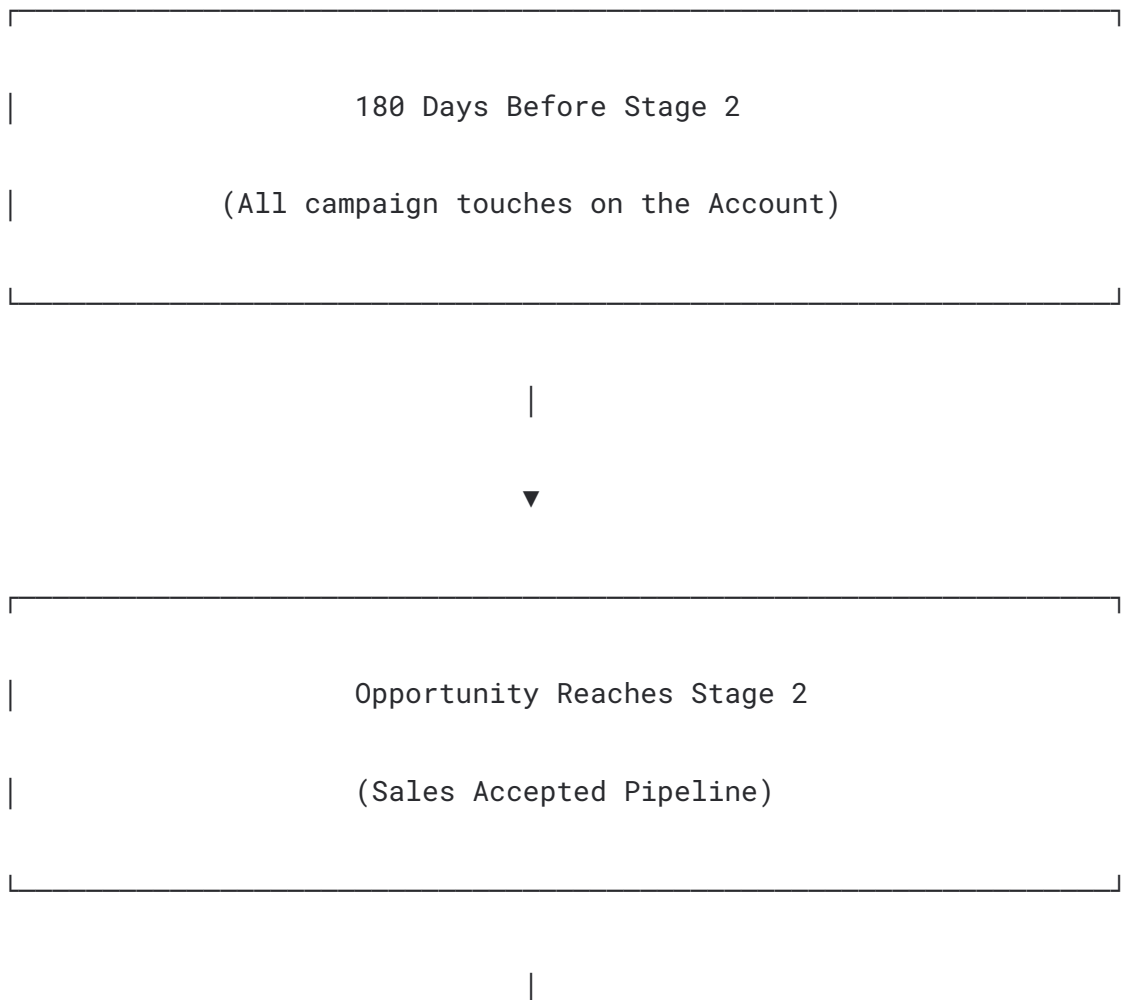
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## Pipeline Generation Attribution

Pipeline attribution measures Marketing's contribution to created pipeline in dollar terms.

This is a **weighted multi-touch model** calculated at the account level.

### How It Works





|                                                         |
|---------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                         |
| Attribution Value = Stage 2 Value                       |
| (Locked in—does not change if deal value changes later) |



|                                              |
|----------------------------------------------|
|                                              |
| Credit Distributed by Channel Weight         |
| (Total attribution = Total pipeline created) |

Key Parameters

| Parameter        | Value                    | Rationale                      |
|------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Lookback Window  | 180 days before Stage 2  | Accounts for long sales cycles |
| Attribution Date | Stage 2 (Sales Accepted) | When pipeline becomes "real"   |

|                   |                      |                                           |
|-------------------|----------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Attribution Value | Stage 2 deal value   | Locked in to prevent fluctuation          |
| Scope             | Account-level        | Contacts often missing from opportunities |
| Model             | Weighted multi-touch | Credit distributed by channel weight      |

## What's Included

**Marketing Campaigns:** All successful campaign engagements within 180 days before Stage 2, including (but not exclusive):

- Events (first-party and third-party)
- Webinars
- Content downloads
- Industry signups
- Nurture engagement
- Paid media conversions
- Website high-value conversions

**Sales Outreach (AE/SDR Cold Outbound):** Included IF:

- AE or SDR outbounds to a contact AND gets a reply
- AND the contact did NOT engage with any Marketing campaign in the prior 30 days

**Deals with No Marketing Touches:** Receive full credit to Sales (ensures total attribution = total pipeline)

## What's Excluded

| Exclusion             | Reason                                                            |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Churns & Contractions | Negative outcomes shouldn't credit Marketing                      |
| Renewals              | Auto-generated, don't follow standard sales process, start at \$0 |
| Touches after Stage 2 | Attribution locked at pipeline creation                           |

## Channel + Content Tracking

Attribution is **inclusive of both channel and content** touches. If a digital ad drives a webinar registration, the ad and the webinar can receive separate attribution credit.

This is enabled by Rampmetrics, which auto-creates SFDC campaigns based on website engagement—allowing granular tracking of digital touches by source, medium, and content.

**Link to:** [\[LINK: Rampmetrics Documentation\]](#)

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## Won Deals Attribution

Won Deals attribution is the **gold standard** for measuring Marketing's contribution to revenue. It captures all touches from 180 days before Stage 2 through deal close.

**Why it's the gold standard:**

- Directly tied to recognized ARR
- Captures full customer journey including deal progression
- Closest measure to true ROI

**Why it's a lagging indicator:**

- Sales cycles can exceed 1 year
- Plus the 180-day lookback window
- Result: Attribution for a won deal may lag the original engagement by 18+ months

**Use for:** Long-term channel performance analysis, annual ROI calculations, strategic planning

**Not useful for:** Near-term campaign feedback, quarterly performance management

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## Pre-Pipeline Attribution

Pre-Pipeline attribution shows deals that **could potentially become attributed pipeline**. These are opportunities currently in Stage 0 or Stage 1 (Discovery) with value, but haven't yet reached Sales Accepted (Stage 2).

**Why it matters:**

- Early indicator of campaign performance
- Shows pipeline that will likely become attributed in coming weeks/months
- Useful for forecasting Marketing's pipeline contribution

**Caveats:**

- Not reported as a core metric
  - Values and inclusion may change before reaching Stage 2
  - Some deals will drop out before becoming sales-accepted
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## Channel Weights

Not all engagements are equal. Channel weights reflect the relative value of different touch types based on historical performance and engagement quality.

| Channel                        | Weight | Notes                         |
|--------------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| Benchtalk - Summit             | 8      | Highest-value owned event     |
| Event - First Party            | 7      | Benchling-hosted events       |
| AE Outreach                    | 6      | Outbound with reply           |
| SDR Outreach                   | 6      | Outbound with reply           |
| Website + Inbound - High Value | 6      | Demo requests, contact forms  |
| Event - Third Party            | 6      | Industry events, booth visits |
| Nurture                        | 6      | High engagement (2+ clicks)   |
| Webinar - Third Party          | 5      | Partner/industry webinars     |



|                               |   |                                  |
|-------------------------------|---|----------------------------------|
| Webinar                       | 5 | Benchmarking webinars            |
| Workshop                      | 5 | Customer workshops               |
| Paid Media                    | 3 | Ad conversions                   |
| In-App Messaging              | 3 | Product-led touches              |
| Website + Inbound - Low Value | 3 | Content downloads, low-intent    |
| Content Syndication           | 1 | Third-party content distribution |

**How weights work:** When calculating a deal's attribution, each touch receives credit proportional to its weight relative to all touches on the deal.

**Example:**

Deal reaches Stage 2 at \$100k value

Touches: Event - First Party (7) + Webinar (5) + Content Syndication (1)

Total weight: 13

Event - First Party:  $\$100k \times (7/13) = \$53,846$

Webinar:  $\$100k \times (5/13) = \$38,462$

Content Syndication:      $\$100k \times (1/13) = \$7,692$

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## First & Last Touch Models

In addition to weighted multi-touch, we track First Touch and Last Touch attribution for channel comparison purposes. These are **not core metrics** but useful for understanding channel roles.

| Model                  | Definition                                              | Useful For                                       |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| First Touch            | First engagement within 180-day window gets 100% credit | Understanding what brings accounts into funnel   |
| Last Touch             | Last engagement before Stage 2 gets 100% credit         | Understanding what converts accounts to pipeline |
| Multi-Touch (Weighted) | Credit distributed by weight across all touches         | Core metric—holistic view of contribution        |

If two more more touches both happened on the same “first/last day” credit is split between both.

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# Technical Details

## Attribution Scope: Account vs. Contact

Attribution is calculated at the **account level**, not contact level. This means all campaign engagements by anyone at the account within the lookback window contribute to attribution.

### Why account-level:

- Contacts are often not associated with opportunities
- Buying committees involve multiple people
- Account-level captures full organizational engagement

**Future consideration:** With [people.ai](#) auto-logging more contacts, contact-level attribution may become viable. Current analysis still shows contacts missing from opportunities.

## Reporting Metrics

| Metric              | Definition                                                               |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| # Deals             | Total number of attributed deals                                         |
| Attributed Pipeline | Sum of weighted attribution \$ by channel                                |
| Incremental Deals   | Weighted percentages summed (implies Marketing "caused" that many deals) |

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# Appendix

## Historical: Pipeline Maturation / Acceleration

**Status:** Deprecated

Pipeline Maturation attempted to attribute every deal value change (positive or negative) throughout the deal lifecycle to the marketing touches that occurred since the last value change.

### Why it was deprecated:

1. **Negative attribution problem:** Sales often started deals at high values and reduced them through qualification. This resulted in Marketing campaigns receiving negative dollar credit for value decreases they didn't cause.
2. **Causation challenge:** It's difficult to argue that a marketing touch directly caused a deal to increase in value mid-cycle. The relationship between engagement and value change is tenuous.
3. **Process issue:** Value fluctuation is primarily a sales forecasting/process issue, not something Marketing should be measured against.

**Decision:** Focus on created pipeline (Stage 2 value) rather than trying to attribute value changes. This provides a cleaner, more defensible metric.

## Historical: Team Source (Pre-FY23)

A rough last-touch model that categorized opportunities as:

- Marketing Qualified (MQL within 45 days of opportunity or qual call)
- SDR Outbound
- AE Outbound
- Other

Replaced by the current multi-touch model in Q4 FY23.

## Definitions

| Term                             | Definition                                                                                    |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Stage 2</b>                   | Sales Accepted opportunity stage—when pipeline becomes "real"                                 |
| <b>Lookback Window</b>           | 180 days before Stage 2 date                                                                  |
| <b>Successful Engagement</b>     | Campaign membership with success status (attended, downloaded, converted—not just registered) |
| <b>Attribution Touch</b>         | A successful campaign engagement within the lookback window                                   |
| <b>Pipeline Generation Value</b> | Total Influenced value of a deal at Stage 2                                                   |

## Known Limitations

| Limitation | Impact | Notes |
|------------|--------|-------|
|------------|--------|-------|

|                          |                                    |                                                              |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Renewals excluded        | ~50% of business not attributed    | Renewals auto-generate at \$0, don't follow standard process |
| Account-level only       | May miss contact-specific patterns | Contacts often missing from opportunities                    |
| 180-day window           | May miss earlier touches           | Tradeoff between relevance and completeness                  |
| Lagging Won Deals metric | Slow feedback loop                 | Sales cycles of 1yr+ mean delayed signal                     |

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